

The Global Juggernaut

Devika Bulchandani, the Global CEO of Ogilvy, derives inspiration from closer home. Relationships and reputation are her guiding mantras

BY KRISHNA GOPALAN

AS OGILVY'S GLOBAL CEO, Devika Bulchandani is always scouting for new ideas. On the impact in today's world, she says, "The pace of change has been incredible. Who would have guessed the impact of Gen AI, and as an industry, we just need to keep adapting."

Bulchandani, who spent her formative years (finished her schooling and college) in India before moving to the US for a Masters, lays stress on two words—relationships and reputation. On the former, she chooses to pick up from the complex Indian family structure. "I am very familiar with the joint family. It helps in understanding relationships well," she says. Dealing with clients and other stakeholders often comes down to dealing with people. It sits well with Ogilvy, which has had long associations with some firms like Unilever (for over a hundred years) and IBM for 30 years. "There is a relationship between the brand and the consumer and is equally important to have a strong one between brand owners."

On reputation, the 55-year-old says, "Our creative work is our reputation and I want the best talent to come to Ogilvy. I want clients to want to be at Ogilvy." In her mind, Ogilvy is not just a communications agency. "We are real business partners to our clients. Creative projects are not vanity projects for us."

For someone who heads such a complex business, such simple thought is what places her on BT's Most Powerful Women in Business list. **BT**

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DEVIKA BULCHANDANI
55, Global CEO, Ogilvy

WHAT ADVICE WOULD YOU GIVE YOUR YOUNGER SELF?

Try to understand your environment and do not try to make the environment understand you

YOUR MANTRA FOR NAVIGATING CHALLENGES?

If you can control it, there's no point stressing about it. And if you can't control it, there's still no point stressing about it



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